

## **SUMMARY WRITING**

### **DEFINITION:**

**A Summary** is a brief or concise account of an event that gives only the main point and not the details. This means that summary must be shorter than the original text.

### **GUIDELINES FOR WRITING A SUMMARY**

1. Read the passage carefully.
2. Extract the main ideas from the paragraphs through the identification of topic sentences if any.
3. Paraphrase the extracted ideas into required number of sentences.
4. Use synonyms.
5. Never exceed the required number of sentences.
6. Answer must be in sentences and not in phrases unless there is a preamble.

**NOTE:** in summary there is no need for the following;

- a. Examples and illustrations.
- b. Analogy: comparison between two situations or processes that seem similar.
- c. Repetition.
- d. The use of flowery language (figures of speech or literary devices)  
e.g. “the man is dark as charcoal” is the man dark?”.
- e. The inclusion of details (unnecessary or irrelevant materials)
- f. The use of link words (connectives- moreover, however, furthermore, as a matter of fact, etc).

**Note:** summary should be clear, straight forward and without blemish.

E.g. “In the time of myth during the period of magic, the destiny of a great kingdom rested on the shoulder of a young boy, his name is Merlin”